Historical years, territory and the estimation sample

Controls: Historical territory, territory year and instrument year.

1. The two historical years have different roles. The territory year determines historical sample availability and, for County and MSA analysis, historical fixed-effect groups. The instrument year chooses the historical population used in the regression. Both offer census years from 1790 to 1900. Modern GDP and employment come from the separately selected modern year.

Territory year 1790 with instrument year 1900 requires usable data in both years. Changing the instrument year does not replace the 1790 fixed-effect groups or State admission cutoff. OLS retains the historical availability restriction used for the IV comparison.

2. State samples follow the year of admission. In State analysis, *Historical States Only* retains states admitted to the Union by the end of the territory year, including admissions during that year. Thus 1790 allows the original 13 states, including Rhode Island but excluding Vermont, Kentucky, Maine and West Virginia. The ceiling is 31 in 1850, 44 in 1890 and 45 in 1900. Missing data can reduce these counts.

State instruments also classify source areas by year-end status: California is included in 1850, and Idaho and Wyoming in 1890. County and MSA analyses retain census-date source classifications; modern West Virginia locations can receive historical Virginia population in those analyses.

Historical States & Territories includes territorial sources without a State admission cutoff. Observations still represent modern states. Their count need not equal the number of historical states and territories.

3. Wider historical coverage need not increase the final sample. A wider scope can introduce unknown population, making a total unavailable. Historical CH averages known populations and offers 80%, 95%, or no area cutoff in both historical years. Coverage counts known-population area, including recorded zeros; border areas are split geographically. Removing the cutoff never overrides State admission eligibility. A finite index, positive assigned population and required prediction inputs remain necessary. State area-weighted population has a separate 95% rule. State analysis covers the 48 contiguous modern states, excluding Alaska, Hawaii and DC.

4. The regression applies further requirements. The sample needs the outcome, instrument, controls and required fixed-effect identities. CH needs complete county inputs. Missing values are not zeros; a log instrument needs a positive value. An eligible state can therefore still be excluded for missing data.